

Robert Wade

ENGINEERING LEADER · PLATFORM & RELIABILITY · PARTNER & PRODUCT · AI-AUGMENTED OPS

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\$100B+

MOBILE COMMERCE DRIVEN

99.99%

PLATFORM UPTIME

130M+

AMAZON CLICKS / MONTH

13 / 2

ENGINEERS · FUNCTIONS OWNED

EXPERTISE

LEADERSHIP

Multi-function org design · Multi-team Agile ceremonies · Hiring & bar-setting · Coaching & career development · Performance management · PERM sponsorship · Exec / VP reporting

PLATFORM RELIABILITY

Incident command · On-call & PagerDuty · Blameless postmortems · SLAs · Observability · Peak-load readiness

PARTNER ENGINEERING

Enterprise integrations · Escalation management · Attribution & event pipelines · Retail media

PRODUCT & DELIVERY

Roadmapping & release planning · Backlog & capacity planning · Feasibility & scoping gates · Cross-functional (product / revenue / support) delivery

DESIGN & UX

Brand & logo design · UI/UX · Figma · Front-end build

AI & AUTOMATION

Claude + MCP · Custom MCP servers · Agentic PRD→ticket pipelines · Generative creative

STACK

BACKEND & DATA

Go · Python · Node.js · Postgres · Aurora · MongoDB · BigQuery

FRONTEND

TypeScript · React · Next.js · Tailwind

CLOUD & INFRA

AWS (ECS, EC2, RDS/Aurora, S3, SES, Route 53) · GCP · Terraform · Docker · GitHub Actions

EDUCATION

A.A.S., Multimedia & Web Design

St. Charles Community College · 2004-2007

CERTIFICATIONS

PROFILE

Senior Engineering Manager at Button owning two engineering functions, Core Engineering and Solutions Engineering, and **13 engineers** behind **\$100B+ in mobile commerce** for Amazon, Walmart, Uber, Lyft, Fetch, and Sam's Club. 19 years in engineering, 10+ in management. I take over unstable orgs and leave behind reliable, automated systems: rebuilt on-call to **99.99% uptime**, held the platform through a Super Bowl at **2.6x its planned peak** with errors flat, and run delivery increasingly on AI-augmented workflows. Also found and run commerce businesses end to end, from engineering and product to brand and design.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Engineering Manager, Core Engineering & Solutions Engineering

Button, Inc. · Oct 2020 - Present · Remote (NYC)

Own two engineering functions and 13 direct reports: Core Engineering (routing, attribution, data, infrastructure) and Solutions Engineering (partner delivery and technical escalation), covering the platform behind \$100B+ in driven mobile commerce, routing 130M+ Amazon creator clicks a month, across 200+ brands including Amazon, Walmart, Uber, Lyft, Fetch, Target, and Sam's Club. I own both the platform and the partner handoff most orgs split and drop.

RELIABILITY & HIGH-TRAFFIC EVENTS: RUN-THE-BUSINESS & KEEP-THE-LIGHTS-ON

- My team owns the **core infrastructure that makes Button run**, the routing, decisioning, attribution, and order pipeline every partner and dollar flows through, and I hold the **RTB/KTLO mandate** for it: reliability, tech-debt, and operational load for systems moving \$100B+ in commerce.
- Lead **Amazon Prime Day readiness** year over year, Button's largest revenue event: capacity planning, load testing, and Go/No-Go across the core services, scaling infrastructure **up to 12x baseline**, proving headroom for each larger ramp at 100% uptime.
- Incident commander through **Fetch's Super Bowl**, holding the platform at **2.6x its planned peak with errors within normal limits**; rebuilt on-call, severity, and blameless postmortems from scratch, sustaining **99.99% uptime** and cutting MTTR.
- Cut **core-engineering interrupts ~30%** by standing up a Support→Data→Core escalation flow, converting reactive firefighting into protected delivery capacity.

SCALE, PLATFORM MODERNIZATION & AI-AUGMENTED OPERATIONS

- Own Button's **order pipeline, the platform's revenue path** (600K+ orders/day): drove autoscaling, **Aurora migrations**, and **ComStore/Django modernization**, and led the release-confidence program (staging parity + end-to-end testing) that **cut release cycles from ~2 months to ~3 weeks**. Backed cost discipline including a single **~\$70K/yr AWS savings**.
- Sponsored internal **read-only LLM tooling** (Sam's Club order debugger and CSV validator) that cut manual triage load, built with tightly scoped tools to prevent hallucination. Championed AI-augmented delivery; org-wide, Claude-attributed code reached **~45% of lines shipped** and ~two-thirds of merged PRs.

SUPPORT ENGINEERING & SERVICE DESIGN

- Stood up Button's partner-support function from scratch. Took support from **100% ad-hoc** (Slack DMs and email, no ownership or routing) to a structured, SLA-backed operation. Architected the **Salesforce→Zendesk→Jira** model (Zendesk as source of truth for routing, prioritization, and SLAs) and formed a Support Engineering team to own it.

- ITIL® Foundation, AXELOS
- Leadership Development Program, Centene

EARLIER

Software Engineer / Web Producer

Centene · 2013-2014

Team Lead, Visual Design

N-Depth Solutions · 2008-2013

Web Developer

Clear Pages · 2007-2008

- Defined **tiered SLAs** and the incident priority matrix across strategic partners (Uber, Amazon, Best Buy, Sam's Club, Fetch): **P0 acknowledged <15 min**, 30-min response for Tier-1, plus the escalation decision tree routing work across Solutions Engineering, Data, and on-call.

PARTNER INTEGRATIONS, PRODUCT & REVENUE

- SE org landed and scaled integrations across a who's-who of commerce, travel, and marketplace: **Amazon, Walmart, Best Buy, Target, Sam's Club, Nike, Lululemon, Puma, Samsung, Expedia, Marriott, Uber One, Lyft, Disney+, and StubHub** (including the Sam's Club Glass/mParticle migration).
- Cut enterprise integration onboarding time **30%** and raised revenue per integration **20%** by standardizing the integration path and removing bespoke per-partner engineering.
- Led formation and initial delivery of Button's **retail media product**: set the roadmap and release plan with product and revenue and shipped initial releases (NY Post, Forbes, BuzzFeed).

ORGANIZATION & DELIVERY LEADERSHIP

- Act as **engineering manager, product manager, and scrum lead** for my org: own the roadmap, backlog prioritization, quarterly capacity planning, and the full Agile cadence across multiple squads, plus the feasibility gate between Revenue, Product, and Engineering on what actually gets built. Early on, led Button's **PostTap** product engineering (post-tap partner experiences) and ran half the org through the post-COVID rebuild.
- Built the team I now run and **lead through managers, not only ICs**: a Solutions Engineering leader (director-track) reports to me directly. Raised the hiring bar, authored the career-growth ladder and design-review process, and sponsored a **PERM labor certification** end to end.

Founder & Principal

Digital Tide · 2023 - Present · Remote

Independent consultancy where I found and run businesses end to end, wearing every hat: **product, engineering, business, growth, and design**. I stand companies up (entity, cloud, email, GTM), build the apps, and design the brand.

- **Sanbar (sanbar.us)**: Built the client's entire technical foundation: GCP and AWS infrastructure, DNS, email and identity, deployment pipeline, and production site.
- **That Paleo Chick (thatpaleochick.com)**: Built the business, not just the site: AWS infrastructure, email, automated social content and scheduling via Postiz, and affiliate monetization, running as a near-fully automated operation.
- **Greedy®**: Ran project management for the full site redesign (scope, vendors, launch) and own social marketing and paid acquisition: a Meta Ad Library-driven competitive playbook plus AI-generated video creative.
- **Charter**: Designed and built an invoicing application end to end: auth, billing entities, invoice generation, and payment tracking.
- **Design & brand**: designed the brand and logo for every company, plus the UI/UX for the apps I've shipped.
- **Digital Tide (digitalti.de)**: Same playbook applied to my own firm, plus the standards clients inherit: Linear-first delivery, GitHub Actions CI, and Slack automation.

IT Manager, Engineering Chapter

Centene Corporation · Jan 2019 - Oct 2020 · St. Louis, MO

- Led **25 engineers across seven cross-functional Agile teams** delivering member-facing web and mobile applications and new health-plan implementations.
- Built the standard engineering process layer for all Web/Mobile matrix teams and defined the metrics leadership used for staffing and prioritization.
- Created a Developer Assessment Framework that made role expectations explicit; top 10% employee engagement across web leadership teams.

IT Manager, Member AI & Mobile → Senior Application Software Engineer

Centene Corporation · Sep 2014 - Jan 2019 · St. Louis, MO

- Built and led the cross-functional team that shipped a **self-service AI health assistant**, reducing call-center volume; established the SDLC framework for the inherited application.
- Delivered **20+ mobile applications** across iOS and Android; launched care management in the Florida market; standardized mobile build, release, and compliance for state contracts.
- As Senior Engineer: shipped OAuth 2.0 via API Gateway, migrated the org from SVN to Git, and mentored ~10 engineers.